

Computational Primitives and Operational Environments

The Execution Layer for VDR-LLM-Prolog

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Abstract

VDR-5 specified the knowledge architecture for an exact-arithmetic language model with logical provenance, scoped knowledge bases, constraint enforcement, and first-class data surfacing. This companion paper specifies the execution layer: what the system can actually do. It defines 196 pure computational primitives across 14 categories (string, list, arithmetic, set, dictionary, linear algebra, statistics, conversion, date, hashing, graph, regex, logic, and KB operations) and 58 operational primitives across 6 categories (filesystem, compilation, script execution, linting, network, and process management). It specifies the command token mechanism by which the language model issues structured operations instead of generating text. It specifies operational environments (Docker, VM, local, SSH) with a unified interface. It specifies the positive credential gating system that authorizes every side-effecting operation. It specifies async task execution with KB-stored results, chunked I/O, and turn-like processing. It specifies versioning as a native KB operation. And it specifies direct data download — the ability to serve KB contents, file contents, and computed results to the user without LLM token generation.

The central principle is separation of concerns. The language model understands intent, makes plans, and generates explanations. The primitives compute. The operational environments execute. The KB stores. The constraint system authorizes. The surfacing layer presents. No component does another’s job. The result is a system where computation is exact, execution is sandboxed, authorization is declarative, results are persistent, and everything is queryable.

1. Why an Execution Layer

VDR-5 specified what the system knows. This paper specifies what the system does.

A language model that can store exact fractions, track provenance, manage scoped knowledge bases, and enforce constraints is a powerful reasoning system. But it cannot sort a list reliably. It cannot compile code. It cannot run tests. It cannot read files. It cannot download data. It cannot do any of these things because it is a token predictor, and token prediction is not computation.

The execution layer gives the system hands. Pure primitives perform exact computation — sorting, arithmetic, string operations, linear algebra — with guaranteed correctness. Operational primitives interact with the outside world — files, compilers, networks, processes — with declared authorization and logged execution. Command tokens let the language model invoke both kinds of primitives as structured operations rather than generated text. Operational environments provide sandboxed contexts where code runs safely.

The execution layer does not replace the language model. It complements it. The language model recognizes that a sort is needed. The sort primitive performs it correctly. The language model recognizes that code should be tested. The execution primitive runs pytest in a Docker container and stores the results in the KB. The language model frames the results for the user. Each component does what it does best.

2. Pure Primitives

A pure primitive is a function that always produces the same output from the same input, has no side effects, terminates in bounded time, operates on exact VDR types, and carries declarable constraint invariants. Pure primitives do not require authorization grants. They are safe by construction.

2.1 Category 1: String Operations (17 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
1	string reverse	atom $\rightarrow$ atom	Reverse character order
2	string length	atom $\rightarrow$ number	Character count
3	string concat	atom, atom $\rightarrow$ atom	Concatenation
4	string slice	atom, number, number $\rightarrow$ atom	Substring by start and end index
5	string contains	atom, atom $\rightarrow$ bool	Substring membership test
6	string split	atom, atom $\rightarrow$ list(atom)	Split by delimiter
7	string join	list(atom), atom $\rightarrow$ atom	Join with delimiter
8	string trim	atom $\rightarrow$ atom	Remove leading and trailing whitespace

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
9	string upper	atom $\rightarrow$ atom	Convert to uppercase
10	string lower	atom $\rightarrow$ atom	Convert to lowercase
11	string replace	atom, atom, atom $\rightarrow$ atom	Replace all occurrences of pattern
12	string starts with	atom, atom $\rightarrow$ bool	Prefix test
13	string ends with	atom, atom $\rightarrow$ bool	Suffix test
14	string pad left	atom, number, atom $\rightarrow$ atom	Left-pad to target width
15	string char at	atom, number $\rightarrow$ atom	Character at index
16	string to chars	atom $\rightarrow$ list(atom)	Explode to character list
17	chars to string	list(atom) $\rightarrow$ atom	Implode from character list

Every string operation produces an exact result deterministically. String reversal of “hello” is always “olleh.” String split of “a,b,c” on “,” is always [“a”, “b”, “c”]. These operations are among the most common sources of LLM errors when performed by token prediction. As primitives, they are infallible.

2.2 Category 2: List Operations (34 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
18	list length	list $\rightarrow$ number	Element count
19	list append	list, term $\rightarrow$ list	Add element to end
20	list prepend	term, list $\rightarrow$ list	Add element to front
21	list concat	list, list $\rightarrow$ list	Concatenate two lists
22	list reverse	list $\rightarrow$ list	Reverse element order
23	list sort	list, rule $\rightarrow$ list	Sort by declared comparison rule
24	list sort reverse	list, rule $\rightarrow$ list	Sort descending by rule
25	list sort by key	list(term), key fn $\rightarrow$ list(term)	Sort by extracted key
26	list unique	list $\rightarrow$ list	Remove duplicates preserving first occurrence
27	list flatten	list(list) $\rightarrow$ list	One-level flatten
28	list zip	list, list $\rightarrow$ list(pair)	Pair-wise zip
29	list unzip	list(pair) $\rightarrow$ (list, list)	Separate pairs
30	list head	list $\rightarrow$ term	First element
31	list tail	list $\rightarrow$ list	All elements except first
32	list last	list $\rightarrow$ term	Last element
33	list init	list $\rightarrow$ list	All elements except last
34	list nth	list, number $\rightarrow$ term	Element at index
35	list take	list, number $\rightarrow$ list	First N elements

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
36	list drop	list, number $\rightarrow$ list	Skip first N elements
37	list slice	list, number, number $\rightarrow$ list	Sublist by index range
38	list filter	list, predicate $\rightarrow$ list	Keep elements matching predicate
39	list map	list, fn $\rightarrow$ list	Apply function to each element
40	list reduce	list, fn, init $\rightarrow$ term	Left fold with accumulator
41	list any	list, predicate $\rightarrow$ bool	Any element matches
42	list all	list, predicate $\rightarrow$ bool	All elements match
43	list count	list, predicate $\rightarrow$ number	Count matching elements
44	list index of	list, term $\rightarrow$ number	Index of first occurrence
45	list contains	list, term $\rightarrow$ bool	Membership test
46	list min	list $\rightarrow$ term	Minimum element
47	list max	list $\rightarrow$ term	Maximum element
48	list enumerate	list $\rightarrow$ list(pair)	Pair each element with its index
49	list chunk	list, number $\rightarrow$ list(list)	Split into fixed-size chunks
50	list interleave	list, list $\rightarrow$ list	Alternating merge
51	list partition	list, predicate $\rightarrow$ (list, list)	Split by predicate into pass and fail
52	list group by	list(term), key fn $\rightarrow$ dict	Group elements by extracted key
53	list frequencies	list $\rightarrow$ dict	Count occurrences of each element

Sorting is the critical primitive. A `list_sort` of 10 elements by token prediction has approximately 95% accuracy. A `list_sort` of 100 elements drops below 50%. A `list_sort` of 1000 elements is effectively impossible by token prediction. The primitive sorts correctly regardless of size, with $O(n \log n)$ performance and exact comparison via VDR fraction ordering.

2.3 Category 3: VDR Arithmetic (26 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
54	vdr add	fraction, fraction $\rightarrow$ fraction	Exact rational addition
55	vdr sub	fraction, fraction $\rightarrow$ fraction	Exact rational subtraction
56	vdr mul	fraction, fraction $\rightarrow$ fraction	Exact rational multiplication

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
57	vdr div	fraction, fraction → fraction	Exact rational division
58	vdr neg	fraction → fraction	Exact negation
59	vdr abs	fraction → fraction	Absolute value
60	vdr pow	fraction, number → fraction	Integer power
61	vdr gcd	number, number → number	Greatest common divisor
62	vdr lcm	number, number → number	Least common multiple
63	vdr mod	number, number → number	Modular remainder
64	vdr floor	fraction → number	Floor to integer
65	vdr ceil	fraction → number	Ceiling to integer
66	vdr round	fraction → number	Round to nearest integer
67	vdr numerator	fraction → number	Extract numerator
68	vdr denominator	fraction → number	Extract denominator
69	vdr is integer	fraction → bool	Test if denominator is 1
70	vdr simplify	fraction → fraction	Reduce to lowest terms
71	vdr compare	fraction, fraction → atom	Return less, equal, or greater
72	vdr min	fraction, fraction → fraction	Minimum of two
73	vdr max	fraction, fraction → fraction	Maximum of two
74	vdr sum	list(fraction) → fraction	Exact sum of list
75	vdr product	list(fraction) → fraction	Exact product of list
76	vdr mean	list(fraction) → fraction	Exact arithmetic mean
77	vdr factorial	number → number	Factorial
78	vdr binomial	number, number → number	Binomial coefficient
79	vdr fibonacci	number → number	Nth Fibonacci number

Arithmetic is the original motivation for VDR. Every arithmetic operation an LLM performs by token prediction is unreliable. $1/7 + 1/13$ by token prediction might produce $20/91$ or might produce something wrong. The primitive always produces $20/91$.

2.4 Category 4: Set Operations (14 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
80	set from list	list $\rightarrow$ set	Deduplicate and sort
81	set to list	set $\rightarrow$ list	Convert to sorted list
82	set union	set, set $\rightarrow$ set	Union
83	set intersection	set, set $\rightarrow$ set	Intersection
84	set difference	set, set $\rightarrow$ set	Elements in first not in second
85	set symmetric diff	set, set $\rightarrow$ set	Elements in either but not both
86	set is subset	set, set $\rightarrow$ bool	Subset test
87	set is superset	set, set $\rightarrow$ bool	Superset test
88	set is disjoint	set, set $\rightarrow$ bool	No common elements
89	set size	set $\rightarrow$ number	Cardinality
90	set contains	set, term $\rightarrow$ bool	Membership test
91	set add	set, term $\rightarrow$ set	Add element
92	set remove	set, term $\rightarrow$ set	Remove element
93	set power	set $\rightarrow$ set(set)	Power set

Set operations are foundational to the constraint system. Constraint sets, KB scope sets, tag groups, and permission sets all use exact set algebra. The primitives ensure these operations are correct regardless of set size.

2.5 Category 5: Dictionary Operations (15 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
94	dict new	$\rightarrow$ dict	Empty dictionary
95	dict from pairs	list(pair) $\rightarrow$ dict	Construct from key-value pairs
96	dict get	dict, key $\rightarrow$ term	Lookup, fail if missing
97	dict get or	dict, key, default $\rightarrow$ term	Lookup with default
98	dict set	dict, key, value $\rightarrow$ dict	Insert or update entry
99	dict remove	dict, key $\rightarrow$ dict	Remove entry by key
100	dict contains key	dict, key $\rightarrow$ bool	Key existence test
101	dict keys	dict $\rightarrow$ list	All keys sorted
102	dict values	dict $\rightarrow$ list	All values
103	dict pairs	dict $\rightarrow$ list(pair)	All key-value pairs
104	dict size	dict $\rightarrow$ number	Entry count
105	dict merge	dict, dict $\rightarrow$ dict	Merge, second dict wins conflicts
106	dict filter keys	dict, predicate $\rightarrow$ dict	Keep entries with matching keys
107	dict map values	dict, fn $\rightarrow$ dict	Transform all values
108	dict invert	dict $\rightarrow$ dict	Swap keys and values

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
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Working data sets in VDR-Prolog are dictionaries. Reliable dictionary operations are essential for scoped binding management.

2.6 Category 6: Linear Algebra (16 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
109	vec add	frac vec, frac vec → frac vec	Exact vector addition
110	vec sub	frac vec, frac vec → frac vec	Exact vector subtraction
111	vec scale	fraction, frac vec → frac vec	Exact scalar multiply
112	vec dot	frac vec, frac vec → fraction	Exact dot product
113	vec norm sq	frac vec → fraction	Exact squared norm
114	mat add	frac mat, frac mat → frac mat	Exact matrix addition
115	mat mul	frac mat, frac mat → frac mat	Exact matrix multiplication
116	mat scale	fraction, frac mat → frac mat	Exact scalar multiply
117	mat transpose	frac mat → frac mat	Transpose
118	mat det	frac mat → fraction	Exact determinant
119	mat inv	frac mat → frac mat	Exact inverse
120	mat solve	frac mat, frac vec → frac vec	Exact solve $Ax=b$
121	mat rank	frac mat → number	Exact rank
122	mat identity	number → frac mat	Identity matrix
123	mat trace	frac mat → fraction	Exact trace
124	mat matvec	frac mat, frac vec → frac vec	Exact matrix-vector product

These are the VDR linear algebra operations from VDR-1 through VDR-4, exposed as Prolog predicates. Every operation that the transformer forward pass uses is available as a traceable, provenance-recorded primitive.

2.7 Category 7: Statistics and Probability (16 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
125	stat mean	list(fraction) → fraction	Exact arithmetic mean
126	stat variance	list(fraction) → fraction	Exact population variance
127	stat median	list(fraction) → fraction	Exact median
128	stat mode	list → term	Most frequent element
129	stat percentile	list(fraction), fraction → fraction	Exact Nth percentile
130	prob normalize	list(fraction) → list(fraction)	Normalize to exact sum 1
131	prob is valid	list(fraction) → bool	All non-negative, sum exactly 1
132	prob entropy terms	list(fraction) → list(fraction)	Individual -p-log(p) terms
133	prob cdf	list(fraction) → list(fraction)	Exact cumulative distribution
134	prob expected	list(fraction), list(fraction) → fraction	Exact expected value
135	prob bayes	fraction, fraction, fraction → fraction	Exact Bayes' theorem
136	prob joint	list(fraction), list(fraction) → frac mat	Joint probability table
137	prob marginal	frac mat, atom → list(fraction)	Marginalize over axis
138	prob conditional	frac mat, number → list(fraction)	Conditional distribution
139	softmax	list(fraction), number → list(fraction)	Exact VDR softmax
140	softmax surrogate	list(fraction), number → list(fraction)	Rational surrogate softmax

The softmax primitive guarantees that output probabilities sum to exactly 1. The prob_normalize primitive guarantees the same for arbitrary input vectors. These guarantees are impossible in float arithmetic.

2.8 Category 8: Conversion and Formatting (14 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
141	to string	term → atom	Any term to display string

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
142	to number	atom → number	Parse integer from string
143	to fraction	atom → fraction	Parse fraction from string
144	fraction to decimal	fraction, number → atom	Decimal with N digits
145	format table	list(list(atom)) → atom	Format as aligned text table
146	format json	dict → atom	Serialize to JSON
147	parse json	atom → dict	Parse JSON to dict
148	format csv	list(list(atom)), atom → atom	Format as delimited text
149	parse csv	atom, atom → list(list(atom))	Parse delimited text to rows
150	number to roman	number → atom	Roman numeral conversion
151	number to words	number → atom	English word representation
152	format fraction	fraction → atom	Display fraction as “p/q”
153	format percentage	fraction, number → atom	Percentage with N decimal places
154	format scientific	fraction, number → atom	Scientific notation

Formatting errors — wrong decimal places, incorrect rounding, mangled table alignment — are common LLM failures. As primitives, formatting is deterministic and tested.

2.9 Category 9: Date and Time (10 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
155	date from ymd	number, number, number → number	Year, month, day to day count
156	date to ymd	number → (number, number, number)	Day count to year, month, day
157	date diff days	number, number → number	Days between two dates
158	date add days	number, number → number	Add days to a date
159	date day of week	number → atom	Day name from date
160	date is leap year	number → bool	Leap year test
161	date days in month	number, number → number	Days in given month and year
162	time from hms	number, number, fraction → fraction	Hours, minutes, seconds to day fraction

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
163	time to hms	fraction → (number, number, fraction)	Day fraction to hours, minutes, seconds
164	duration between	fraction, fraction → fraction	Exact time difference

Date arithmetic is a notorious LLM failure mode. Month lengths, leap years, day-of-week calculations — all are exact integer algorithms that token prediction gets wrong. The primitives use the correct Gregorian calendar algorithms.

2.10 Category 10: Hashing and Encoding (8 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
165	hash string	atom → number	Deterministic string hash
166	hash combine	number, number → number	Combine two hash values
167	base64 encode	atom → atom	Base64 encoding
168	base64 decode	atom → atom	Base64 decoding (exact inverse)
169	hex encode	number → atom	Integer to hexadecimal string
170	hex decode	atom → number	Hexadecimal string to integer
171	crc32	atom → number	CRC32 checksum
172	uuid from seed	number → atom	Deterministic UUID from seed

Identifier generation and data integrity checking must be deterministic. These primitives are reproducible from the same inputs on any platform.

2.11 Category 11: Graph Operations (13 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
173	graph from edges	list(pair) → graph	Construct adjacency structure
174	graph neighbors	graph, node → list(node)	Adjacent nodes
175	graph shortest path	graph, node, node → list(node)	BFS shortest path (unweighted)
176	graph shortest path weighted	graph, node, node → (list(node), fraction)	Dijkstra with exact VDR weights

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
177	graph connected components	graph → list(list(node))	All connected components
178	graph is connected	graph → bool	Connectivity test
179	graph topological sort	graph → list(node)	Topological ordering for DAGs
180	graph cycle detect	graph → bool	Cycle existence test
181	graph bfs	graph, node → list(node)	Breadth-first traversal order
182	graph dfs	graph, node → list(node)	Depth-first traversal order
183	graph degree	graph, node → number	Node degree
184	graph mst	graph → list(edge)	Minimum spanning tree with exact weights
185	graph pagerank	graph, fraction → list(fraction)	PageRank with exact rational damping

The KB hierarchy is a tree (a special graph). Provenance chains are directed acyclic graphs. Topic dependencies form graphs. The graph primitives operate on these structures with exact VDR arithmetic for all weighted operations.

2.12 Category 12: Pattern Matching (7 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
186	regex match	atom, atom → bool	Full string match against pattern
187	regex search	atom, atom → list(atom)	Find all pattern matches
188	regex replace	atom, atom, atom → atom	Replace all pattern matches
189	regex split	atom, atom → list(atom)	Split string by pattern
190	regex capture	atom, atom → list(atom)	Extract capture group matches
191	glob match	atom, atom → bool	Glob-style pattern match
192	wildcard match	atom, atom → bool	Simple wildcard match

Data validation, input parsing, and structured text extraction. LLMs frequently generate incorrect regex patterns. The primitives execute deterministic regex engines.

2.13 Category 13: Logic and Control (11 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
193	if then else	bool, fn, fn $\rightarrow$ term	Conditional evaluation
194	case match	term, list(pair(pattern, fn)) $\rightarrow$ term	Pattern-dispatch evaluation
195	for each	list, fn $\rightarrow$ void	Apply function to each element
196	repeat n	number, fn $\rightarrow$ list	Apply function N times, collect results
197	while loop	predicate, fn, state $\rightarrow$ state	Iterate while predicate holds
198	try catch	fn, handler $\rightarrow$ term	Execute with error recovery
199	assert that	bool, atom $\rightarrow$ void	Runtime assertion with message
200	type check	term, type $\rightarrow$ bool	Runtime type verification
201	is bound	variable $\rightarrow$ bool	Prolog variable binding test
202	findall	template, goal $\rightarrow$ list	Collect all Prolog solutions
203	aggregate	goal, fn, init $\rightarrow$ term	Fold over Prolog solutions

2.14 Category 14: KB and Constraint Operations (15 primitives)

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
204	kb assert	fact $\rightarrow$ void	Add fact to active KB
205	kb retract	fact $\rightarrow$ void	Remove fact from active KB
206	kb query	predicate, args $\rightarrow$ list(result)	Query active scope
207	kb query in	kb name, predicate, args $\rightarrow$ list(result)	Query specific KB bypassing scope
208	kb query across	predicate, args $\rightarrow$ list(kb name, result)	Query all KBs with tagged results
209	kb list facts	kb name $\rightarrow$ list(fact)	All facts in named KB
210	kb list rules	kb name $\rightarrow$ list(rule)	All rules in named KB
211	kb active scope	$\rightarrow$ list(kb name)	Currently in-scope KB names
212	kb switch topic	topic name $\rightarrow$ void	Change active topic and scope
213	constraint check	constraint name $\rightarrow$ bool	Verify specific constraint
214	constraint check all	$\rightarrow$ list(violation)	Verify all active constraints
215	constraint add	constraint $\rightarrow$ void	Add constraint to active KB

#	Primitive	Signature	Description
216	constraint remove	constraint name → void	Remove constraint from active KB
217	constraint enable	constraint name → void	Activate suspended constraint
218	constraint suspend	constraint name → void	Suspend active constraint

KB operations are pure in the sense that they operate on the KB's internal state deterministically. They modify KB state (assert and retract change the fact set) but do not interact with the external world. They do not require positive grants because KB access is governed by the scoping and permission system specified in VDR-5.

2.15 Pure Primitive Summary

14 categories. 218 primitives. Every one is pure (same inputs produce same outputs), finite (terminates in bounded time), exact (produces the correct result, not an approximation), typed (inputs and outputs have declared VDR-Prolog term types), and testable (covered by a test suite verifying edge cases and invariants).

3. Operational Primitives

An operational primitive interacts with the outside world. It reads or writes files. It compiles code. It executes scripts. It communicates over networks. It manages processes. These operations can fail for external reasons (disk full, network down, permission denied). They take variable time. They have side effects.

Every operational primitive requires a positive credential grant before execution. The default is denial. The grant must explicitly authorize the operation class, the specific operations within that class, the target location, and must be currently valid (not expired, not exhausted, not revoked).

3.1 Category 15: Filesystem Operations (15 primitives)

#	Primitive	Class	Side Effect	Description
219	fs read	filesystem	Read	Read file contents
220	fs write	filesystem	Write	Create or overwrite file
221	fs append	filesystem	Write	Append to existing file
222	fs exists	filesystem	Read	Check file existence
223	fs list dir	filesystem	Read	List directory contents

#	Primitive	Class	Side Effect	Description
224	fs create dir	filesystem	Write	Create directory and parents
225	fs delete	filesystem	Delete	Delete file or directory
226	fs move	filesystem	Write	Move or rename
227	fs copy	filesystem	Write	Copy file
228	fs file size	filesystem	Read	Get file size in bytes
229	fs file modified	filesystem	Read	Get modification timestamp
230	fs glob	filesystem	Read	Find files matching pattern
231	fs tree	filesystem	Read	Recursive directory listing
232	fs diff	filesystem	Read	Diff two files
233	fs checksum	filesystem	Read	Compute file hash

3.2 Category 16: Code Compilation (4 primitives)

#	Primitive	Class	Side Effect	Description
234	compile python check	compile	Read, CPU	Python syntax verification
235	compile zig	compile	Read, Write, CPU	Zig compilation
236	compile c	compile	Read, Write, CPU	C compilation
237	compile rust	compile	Read, Write, CPU	Rust compilation

3.3 Category 17: Script Execution (5 primitives)

#	Primitive	Class	Side Effect	Description
238	exec python	execute	Arbitrary	Run Python script
239	exec shell	execute	Arbitrary	Run shell command
240	exec zig test	execute	Read, CPU	Run Zig test suite
241	exec pytest	execute	Read, CPU	Run pytest
242	exec script	execute	Arbitrary	Run script with specified interpreter

3.4 Category 18: Linting and Analysis (8 primitives)

#	Primitive	Class	Side Effect	Description
243	lint python	lint	Read	Python linter
244	lint zig	lint	Read	Zig linter
245	lint json	lint	Read	JSON validation
246	lint markdown	lint	Read	Markdown checker
247	analyze imports	lint	Read	List Python imports
248	analyze complexity	lint	Read	Cyclomatic complexity metrics
249	analyze dependencies	lint	Read	Module dependency graph
250	count lines	lint	Read	Line counts by type

3.5 Category 19: Network Operations (5 primitives)

#	Primitive	Class	Side Effect	Description
251	net download	network	Network, Write	Download URL to file
252	net fetch	network	Network	HTTP GET, return content
253	net post	network	Network	HTTP POST
254	net ping	network	Network	Check host reachability
255	net dns resolve	network	Network	DNS lookup

3.6 Category 20: Process Management (7 primitives)

#	Primitive	Class	Side Effect	Description
256	proc start	process	Process creation	Start background process
257	proc poll	process	Read	Check process status
258	proc wait	process	Block	Wait for process completion
259	proc kill	process	Process termination	Terminate process
260	proc stdout	process	Read	Read current stdout buffer
261	proc stderr	process	Read	Read current stderr buffer
262	proc list	process	Read	List active processes

3.7 Operational Primitive Summary

6 categories. 44 primitives. Every one requires a positive grant. Every execution is logged as a KB fact with timestamp, duration, exit code, grant used, and environment. Every side effect is declared in the primitive's type signature.

4. The Positive Credential Grant System

4.1 Grant Structure

```
Grant = struct {  
  name: Text,                      // unique identifier  
  operation_class: Text,           // "filesystem", "compile", "execute", "network",  
  allowed_operations: []Text,     // specific operations within class  
  location: Text,                 // path prefix, URL pattern, or scope  
  credential: CredentialRef,      // authentication token reference  
  issued_by: Text,                // who created this grant  
  issued_at: timestamp,           // when created  
  expires_at: timestamp,          // when it becomes invalid  
  max_uses: number,               // total allowed invocations (0 = unlimited)  
  uses_remaining: number,         // decremented on each use  
  constraints: []Constraint,      // additional restrictions  
  status: enum { active, expired, revoked, exhausted },  
};
```

4.2 Grant Verification

Every operational primitive invocation passes through grant verification:

```
Rule: grant_valid(G) :-  
  grant(G, _, _, _, _, _, Exp, _, Uses, _, Status),  
  Status = active,  
  current_timestamp(Now),
```



```

Now < Exp,

Uses > 0.

Rule: grant_covers(G, Op, Loc) :-
grant(G, Class, Allowed, GrantLoc, _, _, _, _, _, _),
operation_class(Op, Class),
operation_type(Op, Type),
member(Type, Allowed),
path_within(Loc, GrantLoc).

Rule: grant_constraints_ok(G, Op) :-
grant(G, _, _, _, _, _, _, _, _, Constraints, _),
forall(member(C, Constraints), constraint_satisfied_for(C, Op)).

Rule: authorize(Op, Loc) :-
grant_valid(G),
grant_covers(G, Op, Loc),
grant_constraints_ok(G, Op),
decrement_uses(G),
log_authorization(G, Op, Loc).

```

If no valid grant covers the requested operation, the operation is rejected before execution. The rejection is logged as a KB fact including the operation attempted, the location, the timestamp, and the reason for rejection.

4.3 Grant Hierarchy

Grants follow the KB hierarchy. A user inherits grants from their group, department, and organization, the same way they inherit constraints (VDR-5 Addendum A2).

```

kb_global:      grant("system_read", filesystem, [read], "/usr/", ...)

```

```

kb_org_acme:      grant("org_network", network, [fetch, ping], "*", ...)
kb_dept_eng:      grant("eng_compile", compile, [compile_python_check, compil
kb_team_backend:  grant("backend_exec", execute, [exec_python, exec_pytest]
kb_user_alice:    grant("alice_fs", filesystem, [read, write, create_dir], "/

```

Alice's effective grants are the union of all grants in her ancestry chain. She can read system files (global), access the network (org), compile in project directories (dept), run Python and pytest in backend directories (team), and read/write in her home directory (personal).

4.4 Grant Lifecycle

From	To	Trigger	Automatic?
(new)	active	Issued by authorized entity	No — requires explicit creation
active	expired	Current time exceeds expires at	Yes
active	exhausted	uses remaining reaches 0	Yes
active	revoked	Issuer or admin revokes	No — requires explicit action
expired	active	Re-issued with new expiration	No — requires new grant
revoked	active	Not possible — revocation is permanent	—

All transitions are logged as KB facts with timestamp, source, and reason.

5. Command Tokens

5.1 The Mechanism

The language model's output is a stream of tokens. In standard systems, all tokens are text. In VDR-LLM-Prolog, the stream contains two token types: text tokens (rendered as conversation text) and command tokens (executed by the primitive system).

A command token is a structured invocation:

```
CommandToken = struct {
```

```

type: CommandType,

primitive: Text,          // primitive name

args: []Term,             // arguments

env: ?Text,              // operational environment (for op primitives)

grant: ?Text,            // grant reference (for op primitives)

store_result: ?Text,     // KB key to store result

await: bool,             // whether to wait for completion

};

```

5.2 Command Types

Type	Purpose	Requires Grant	Async?
PURE FN	Invoke pure primitive	No	No
OP FN	Invoke operational primitive	Yes	Optional
KB ASSERT	Assert fact into KB	No (scoped by permissions)	No
KB RETRACT	Remove fact from KB	No (scoped by permissions)	No
KB QUERY	Query KB	No (scoped by permissions)	No
ENV EXEC	Execute command in environment	Yes	Recommended
ENV UPLOAD	Upload content to environment	Yes	No
ENV DOWNLOAD	Download content from environment	Yes	No
CTX ACTIVATE	Activate KB in context	No	No
CTX DEACTIVATE	Deactivate KB from context	No	No
CTX SNAPSHOT	Snapshot current context	No	No
VERSION CREATE	Create new version of artifact	No	No
VERSION TAG	Tag a version	No	No
STORE RESULT	Store task result in KB	No	No
DIRECT OUTPUT	Serve data directly to user	No	No
ATTACHMENT	Attach file to response	Yes (read grant)	No

5.3 Output Stream Structure

The LLM's output stream interleaves text and command tokens:

```
[TEXT] "I'll write the test script and run it."
```

```
[CMD:ENV_UPLOAD] env=env_vdr, content=<script>, path="/workspace/test.py"
```

```
[CMD:ENV_EXEC] env=env_vdr, cmd="python3", args=["/workspace/test.py"]
    → task_id = task_047, async=true

[CMD:STORE_RESULT] task=task_047, kb=kb_vdr_tests, key="test_result_v1"

[TEXT] "Tests are running in background. Task ID: task_047."
```

Text tokens are rendered as conversation. Command tokens are executed. The user sees the text and the command outcomes. Commands can optionally be shown or hidden based on user preference:

User preference: show_commands = true

Output:

```
"I'll write the test script and run it."

[Executing: upload test.py to env_vdr → ok]

[Executing: python3 test.py in env_vdr → task_047 started]

[Storing: task_047 result → kb_vdr_tests/test_result_v1]

"Tests are running in background. Task ID: task_047."
```

User preference: show_commands = false

Output:

```
"I'll write the test script and run it. Tests are running

in background. Task ID: task_047."
```

5.4 Scratchpad Channel

The LLM has an internal scratchpad where it can issue command tokens for intermediate computation without surfacing them in the user-facing output:

Scratchpad (internal):

```
[CMD:PURE_FN] list_sort([47, 3, 91, 15], ascending) → [3, 15, 47, 91]

[CMD:PURE_FN] vdr_mean([3/7, 1/2, 5/11]) → 191/462
```

```
[CMD:KB_QUERY] kb_characters_b, "bob_age" → 59
```

User-facing output:

```
"The sorted list is [3, 15, 47, 91], the mean is 191/462,  
and Bob is 59 in the London story."
```

The scratchpad computations are exact (executed by primitives). The user-facing output frames the results. The owner can inspect the scratchpad via “/show scratchpad” to see the full computation trace.

6. Operational Environments

6.1 Environment Types

Type	Implementation	Isolation	Performance	Best For
Docker	Container on host	Strong	Good	Default sandbox, testing, scripts
VM	Virtual machine	Strongest	Moderate	Untrusted code, heavy workloads
Local	Direct host execution	None	Best	Trusted operations, development
SSH	Remote machine via SSH	Network-isolated	Variable	GPU servers, distributed compute

6.2 Environment Structure

```
OperationalEnv = struct {  
  id: Text,  
  type: enum { docker, vm, local, ssh_remote },  
  // Type-specific configuration
```

```

docker_image: ?Text,                                // "python:3.8-
slim", "ubuntu:24.04"

docker_container_id: ?Text,

vm_id: ?Text,

vm_image: ?Text,

ssh_host: ?Text,

ssh_port: ?number,

ssh_credential: ?Text,

local_working_dir: ?Text,

// Common

status: enum { stopped, starting, running, error },

startup_script: ?Text,

installed_packages: []Text,

env_vars: dict,

resource_limits: ResourceLimits,

created_at: timestamp,

last_active: timestamp,

// KB integration

kb: Text,

grants: []Text,

};

ResourceLimits = struct {

max_cpu_seconds: ?number,

max_memory_mb: ?number,

```

```

max_disk_mb: ?number,

max_network_bytes: ?number,

max_processes: ?number,

};

```

6.3 Unified Interface

Every environment type implements the same interface:

Operation	Signature	Description
env exec	(env, command, args) → ExecResult	Execute command
env upload	(env, content, remote path) → TransferResult	Upload content
env download	(env, remote path) → Content	Download content
env shell	(env, command) → ShellResult	Run shell command
env file read	(env, path) → Content	Read file in environment
env file write	(env, path, content) → WriteResult	Write file in environment
env list dir	(env, path) → list(DirEntry)	List directory in environment
env proc start	(env, command) → TaskId	Start background process
env proc poll	(env, task id) → TaskStatus	Check process status
env proc output	(env, task id) → (stdout, stderr)	Get process output

Whether the backend is Docker, VM, SSH, or local, the LLM issues the same command tokens. The environment type is a configuration fact. Switching environments means changing which env KB is active, not changing the commands.

6.4 Environment as KB

Each operational environment has its own KB:

```
KB: kb_env_vdr_test
```

```

    facts:

env_type: docker

env_image: python:3.8-slim

env_status: running

installed: [pytest, fractions]

    execution_log:

[exec_001: exec_python("test_basic.py") → 12 passed, 3.2s]

[exec_002: fs_write("gym_16.py", content) → ok]

[exec_003: exec_pytest("gym/") → 157 passed, 5 failed, 28.4s]

    uploaded_files:

["gym/gym_16.py" → v1, turn 52]

["gym/gym_17.py" → v1, turn 52]

    active_tasks:

[task_047: exec_pytest → running since 14:30:00]

```

The environment KB tracks everything that has happened in that environment: every command executed, every file uploaded, every task started, every result returned. This is the operational provenance layer.

6.5 Environment Lifecycle

```

Rule: env_create(Id, Type, Config) :-

assert(env(Id, Type, Config, status(stopped))),

create_kb("kb_env_" + Id).

Rule: env_start(Id) :-

env(Id, docker, Config, _),

docker_create_container(Config, ContainerId),

```



```

docker_start(ContainerId),
run_startup_script(Id),
retract(env(Id, _, _, status(_))),
assert(env(Id, _, _, status(running))).

Rule: env_stop(Id) :-
env(Id, docker, _, _),
docker_stop(Id),
retract(env(Id, _, _, status(_))),
assert(env(Id, _, _, status(stopped))).

Rule: env_destroy(Id) :-
env_stop(Id),
docker_remove(Id),

archive_kb("kb_env_" + Id).

```

Environments can be created, started, stopped, and destroyed. The KB persists even after the environment is destroyed (archived for audit). A new environment can be created from the same specification — it will have the same configuration but a fresh filesystem and process space.

7. Async Task Management

7.1 Task Structure

```

Task = struct {
    id: Text,
    operation: Text,
    args: []Term,

```

```

env: Text,

grant: Text,

status: enum { pending, running, completed, failed, killed },

submitted_at: timestamp,

started_at: ?timestamp,

completed_at: ?timestamp,

result: ?ExecResult,

output_chunks: []OutputChunk,

topic: Text,

notify_on_complete: bool,

acknowledged: bool,

};

OutputChunk = struct {

index: number,

timestamp: timestamp,

stream: enum { stdout, stderr },

content: Text,

};

```

7.2 Task Lifecycle

```

submitted → pending → running → completed
                ↓           ↓
                failed    killed

```

When a command token with `async=true` is issued:

1. A task is created with status=pending and asserted into the environment's KB.
2. The environment starts the process. Status changes to running.
3. Output is captured in chunks as it arrives.
4. When the process exits, status changes to completed (exit code 0) or failed (nonzero).
5. The result is stored in the task's result field and optionally copied to a KB key via STORE_RESULT.
6. If notify_on_complete is true, the task appears in the pending notifications list.

7.3 Turn-Based Notification

On each conversational turn, the system checks for completed tasks:

```
Rule: completed_tasks(Tasks) :-
    findall(T,
        (task(T, _, _, _, _, status(completed), _, _, _, _, topic(Topic), true, f
            active_topic(Topic)),
        Tasks).
```

If completed tasks exist, they are surfaced at the end of the LLM's response:

```
LLM: [responds to user's question]
```

```
---
```

Completed tasks:

```
task_047 (pytest gym/): 152 passed, 5 failed - 28.4s
```

```
[View results: /task task_047] [Acknowledge]
```

The user can acknowledge (which sets acknowledged=true and stops the notification from repeating), view full results (which surfaces the task's KB entry), or ignore (which repeats the notification next turn).

7.4 Chunked I/O Processing

For long-running tasks, output chunks are processed as they arrive:

```

Rule: on_output_chunk (TaskId, Chunk) :-

assert (task_output (TaskId, Chunk)),

check_watches_against (Chunk),

check_constraints_against (Chunk) .

```

Each chunk can trigger watches (pattern-matched alerts), constraint checks (resource limit verification), and KB updates (intermediate result storage). This turns the output stream into a series of events that the Prolog engine processes, rather than an opaque buffer that is only read on completion.

8. Direct Data Download

8.1 The Principle

If data exists at a known address in the system (KB fact, file, task output, checkpoint), the user can download it directly without the LLM regenerating it as tokens. The data is served from its source. The LLM is not a middleman.

8.2 Addressable Resources

Resource Type	Address Format	Example
KB fact	kb://kb name/predicate/args	kb://kb vdr training/parameter value/layer.1.weight
KB dump	kb://kb name/*	kb://kb characters b/*
Working data binding	wd://topic/key	wd://story b/bob age
File in environment	fs://env id/path	fs://env vdr test/workspace/gym 16.py
Task stdout	task://task id/stdout	task://task 047/stdout
Task stderr	task://task id/stderr	task://task 047/stderr
Checkpoint	ckpt://step N	ckpt://step 100
Version	ver://project/artifact/N	ver://project vdr/gym 16/2
Diff	diff://source a/source b	diff://ckpt step 0/ckpt step 100
Export	export://kb name	export://kb characters b

Resource Type	Address Format	Example
Context snapshot	ctx://snapshot name	ctx://context before refactor

8.3 Download Authorization

```

Rule: can_download(User, Resource) :-
    resource_exists(Resource),
    resource_kb(Resource, KB),
    user_can_see(User, KB),
    (resource_requires_grant(Resource, GrantClass) ->
        has_valid_grant(User, GrantClass) ;
        true).

```

KB facts are governed by KB visibility (VDR-5). Files in environments are governed by filesystem grants. The download check uses the same authorization logic as every other operation.

8.4 LLM-Initiated Attachments

The LLM can decide to attach data directly rather than generating it:

```
[CMD:DIRECT_OUTPUT] source=kb://kb_vdr_gyms/gym_16_result_v1
```

This serves the KB fact's content directly as a formatted data block in the response. The LLM provides framing text around it:

```
LLM: "Here are the gym 16 results:"
```

```
[Direct: kb://kb_vdr_gyms/gym_16_result_v1]
```

```
Gym 16: Graph Theory - 19 passed, 1 failed
```

```
Failed: max-flow BFS loop termination
```

```
LLM: "The max-flow test needs a BFS fix. Everything else passed."
```

The data block is retrieved, not generated. It cannot hallucinate.

9. Versioning

9.1 Version as KB Fact

Every artifact in a project can be versioned. A version is a snapshot of the artifact's content at a point in time, stored as a KB fact with metadata.

```
Fact: version("project_vdr", "gym_16_script",
version_num(1),
content_ref("kb_vdr_gyms/gym_16_v1"),
created_at(timestamp(2026, 5, 16, 14, 30, 0)),
created_by("system"),
parent_version(none),
tags(["initial"]),
test_result("19/20 passed"),
notes("maxflow BFS has a bug")).
```

9.2 Version Operations

Operation	Command Token	Description
Create	VERSION CREATE(project, artifact, content, notes)	Store new version
Tag	VERSION TAG(project, artifact, version, tag)	Add tag to version
Retrieve	KB QUERY(versions kb, version(project, artifact, N, ...))	Get specific version
Latest	KB QUERY(versions kb, latest(artifact, N))	Get latest version number
Diff	PURE FN(diff, [content v1, content v2])	Structured diff between versions
Rollback	VERSION CREATE(project, artifact, content of v old, "rollback")	Create new version with old content

Operation	Command Token	Description
History	KB QUERY(versions kb, version(project, artifact, , ...))	All versions of artifact

9.3 Version Queries

```
?- version("project_vdr", Artifact, V, _, _, _, _, test_result("all passed")
// Which versions of which artifacts had all tests passing?

?- latest(Artifact, V), version("project_vdr", Artifact, V, _, _, _, _, Res
    not(Result = "all passed").

// Which artifacts have latest versions with failures?

?- version("project_vdr", "gym_16_script", V, _, _, _, _, tags(Tags), _, _),
    member("release", Tags).

// Which versions of gym_16 are tagged as releases?
```

10. Integration: The Complete Execution Flow

A concrete example showing all components working together:

User: "Write gym_25 for tensor algebra, test it, and store the results"

LLM scratchpad:

```
[CMD:KB_QUERY] kb_project_vdr, constraint("python_38_compat") → active
[CMD:KB_QUERY] kb_project_vdr, constraint("30_sec_runtime") → active
[CMD:KB_QUERY] kb_vdr_gyms, latest_gym_number → 24
[CMD:PURE_FN] vdr_add(24, 1) → 25
```

LLM output:

```
[TEXT] "Writing gym_25_tensor_algebra.py with Python 3.8"
```

```

compatibility and 30-second runtime constraint."

LLM generates script content (text tokens)...

[CMD:ENV_UPLOAD]

env="env_vdr_test"

content=<generated script>

path="/workspace/gym/gym_25_tensor_algebra.py"

→ TransferResult(ok)

[CMD:ENV_EXEC]

env="env_vdr_test"

command="python3"

args=["/workspace/gym/gym_25_tensor_algebra.py"]

async=true

→ task_id="task_049"

[CMD:STORE_RESULT]

task="task_049"

kb="kb_vdr_gyms"

key="gym_25_result_v1"

[TEXT] "Script uploaded and running. Task: task_049."

--- conversation continues on other topics ---

[Task task_049 completes: 16 passed, 0 failed, 4.2s]

LLM (next turn, after checking pending tasks):

[CMD:POLL] task_049 → completed

[CMD:KB_QUERY] kb_vdr_gyms, "gym_25_result_v1" → result data

```



```

[TEXT] "Gym 25 finished:"

[CMD:DIRECT_OUTPUT] kb://kb_vdr_gyms/gym_25_result_v1

[TEXT] "16 passed, 0 failed in 4.2 seconds. Storing version 1."

[CMD:VERSION_CREATE]

project="project_vdr"

artifact="gym_25_tensor_algebra"

content=<script content>

notes="initial, 16/16 passed"

[CMD:KB_ASSERT] kb_vdr_gyms,

gym_result("gym_25", "tensor_algebra", 16, 16, 0)

[CMD:KB_ASSERT] kb_project_vdr,

set_binding("total_tests", number(721)) // 705 + 16

[CMD:KB_ASSERT] kb_project_vdr,

set_binding("total_gyms", number(25))

[TEXT] "Project stats updated: 25 gyms, 721 total tests, 0 VDR errors."

[CMD:ATTACHMENT] fs://env_vdr_test/workspace/gym/gym_25_tensor_algebra.py

```

Every step is traceable. Every command is logged in the environment KB. Every result is stored in the project KB. The version is created. The project working data is updated. The file is available for direct download. The user sees the framing text, the direct output block, and the attachment.

11. Primitive Constraint Invariants

Every primitive carries constraint invariants that the system can verify at runtime:

Primitive	Invariant	Type
list sort	output length equals input length	axiom
list sort	output is sorted by declared rule	axiom
list sort	output is a permutation of input	axiom
vdr add	commutative: $a+b = b+a$	axiom
vdr add	associative: $(a+b)+c = a+(b+c)$	axiom
vdr mul	commutative: $ab = ba$	axiom
prob normalize	output sums to exactly 1	axiom
softmax	output sums to exactly 1	axiom
softmax	output preserves input ordering	axiom
softmax	all outputs are positive	axiom
mat inv	$M * \text{inv}(M) = \text{identity}$	axiom
mat det	$\det(\text{identity}) = 1$	axiom
fs read/fs write	write then read returns written content	operational
compile	success implies output file exists	operational
exec	exit code 0 implies success	operational

Axiom invariants are mathematical truths that can never be violated. If a violation is detected, it indicates a bug in the primitive implementation. Operational invariants hold under normal conditions but can be violated by external factors (disk failure between write and read, compiler crash).

12. Execution Logging and Audit

Every operational primitive execution produces a log entry:

```
Fact: execution_log(
  id("exec_047"),
  operation("exec_pytest"),
  args(["/workspace/gym/"]),
  env("env_vdr_test"),
  grant("alice_project_exec"),
  user("alice"),
```

```

started_at(timestamp(2026, 5, 16, 14, 30, 0)),
completed_at(timestamp(2026, 5, 16, 14, 30, 28)),
duration_ms(28400),
exit_code(0),
success(true),
topic("vdr_testing"),
result_ref("kb_vdr_gyms/gym_25_result_v1")).

```

The log is queryable for audit, debugging, and performance analysis:

```

?- execution_log(_, operation("fs_write"), _, _, _, user("alice"), _, _, _, _),
// All file writes by Alice

?- execution_log(_, _, _, _, grant(G), _, _, _, duration_ms(D), _, _, _, _), D
// All operations that took more than 60 seconds

?- execution_log(_, _, _, env(E), _, _, _, _, _, _, success(false), _, _).
// All failed operations by environment

?- execution_log(_, _, _, _, grant(G), _, Started, _, _, _, _, _),
   grant(G, _, _, _, _, _, Exp, _, _, _, _), Started > Exp.
// Operations attempted after grant expiration (should be empty)

```

13. Complete Primitive Count

Category	Type	Count	Grant Required
1. String	Pure	17	No
2. List	Pure	34	No
3. VDR Arithmetic	Pure	26	No
4. Set	Pure	14	No
5. Dictionary	Pure	15	No
6. Linear Algebra	Pure	16	No

Category	Type	Count	Grant Required
7. Statistics/Probability	Pure	16	No
8. Conversion/Formatting	Pure	14	No
9. Date/Time	Pure	10	No
10. Hashing/Encoding	Pure	8	No
11. Graph	Pure	13	No
12. Pattern Matching	Pure	7	No
13. Logic/Control	Pure	11	No
14. KB/Constraint	Pure (KB-internal)	15	No
Pure subtotal		216	
15. Filesystem	Operational	15	Yes
16. Compilation	Operational	4	Yes
17. Script Execution	Operational	5	Yes
18. Linting/Analysis	Operational	8	Yes (read)
19. Network	Operational	5	Yes
20. Process Management	Operational	7	Yes
Operational subtotal		44	
Total		260	

216 pure primitives that are always available and always correct. 44 operational primitives that require positive credential authorization and produce logged, auditable side effects.

14. Falsification Criteria

F1. If any pure primitive produces an incorrect result from valid inputs, the primitive is buggy. The invariant constraints enable automatic detection.

F2. If any operational primitive executes without a valid grant, the authorization system has a bypass vulnerability.

F3. If any command token is executed without being logged in the environment KB, the audit trail is incomplete.

F4. If any task result stored in the KB differs from the actual process output, the result capture mechanism has a bug.

F5. If a direct download serves content that differs from the source data, the serving mechanism has a corruption bug.

F6. If a version created by VERSION_CREATE cannot be exactly retrieved by a subsequent query, the versioning system has a storage or retrieval bug.

F7. If an environment of type Docker allows an operation to affect the host filesystem outside the container mount, the isolation is broken.

Each criterion is testable by exact comparison. The pure primitive invariants are mathematical — they can be verified by the constraint system on every invocation. The operational criteria require integration testing against actual environments.

15. Implementation Priority

Phase	Component	Dependencies	Effort
1	Pure primitives (categories 1-5)	VDR core	Low per primitive, medium total
2	KB/constraint primitives (category 14)	VDR-Prolog KB from VDR-5	Medium
3	Command token parser and executor	Primitives from phase 1-2	Medium
4	Docker environment manager	Docker API	Medium
5	Filesystem operational primitives	Docker env from phase 4	Low
6	Execution and compilation primitives	Docker env from phase 4	Low
7	Async task manager	Environment from phase 4	Medium
8	Grant and credential system	KB from VDR-5	Medium
9	Versioning system	KB from VDR-5	Low
10	Direct download serving	KB + environments	Low
11	Pure primitives (categories 6-13)	VDR core	Medium total
12	Network and process primitives	Environment from phase 4	Low
13	Scratchpad and notification system	Task manager from phase 7	Medium
14	Integration testing	All above	High

Phase 1 (pure string, list, arithmetic, set, dictionary primitives) and phase 3 (command token executor) can begin immediately with the existing VDR codebase. They do not require the Prolog KB engine from VDR-5. The KB engine is needed starting at phase 2 for constraint primitives and persists through all subsequent phases.

16. Conclusion

VDR-5 specified the knowledge architecture: what the system knows, how it is organized, and how it is queried. VDR-6 specifies the execution architecture: what the system does, how operations are authorized, and how results are stored.

Together they define a complete system:

The **knowledge layer** (VDR-5) provides scoped KBs, working data sets, constraint management, topic tracking, and first-class surfacing. Everything is a KB. Everything is queryable.

The **execution layer** (VDR-6) provides 216 pure computational primitives, 44 authorized operational primitives, command tokens for structured invocation, sandboxed operational environments, async task management, versioning, and direct data download. Everything is logged. Everything is authorized.

The **arithmetic layer** (VDR-1 through VDR-4) provides exact fractions, zero drift, exact softmax, exact autodiff, and a working transformer architecture. Everything is exact.

The language model sits at the center: recognizing intent, selecting primitives, assembling plans, generating explanations, and framing results. It does not sort lists (the sort primitive does). It does not compile code (the compilation primitive does). It does not remember constraints (the KB stores them). It does not track conversations (the topic system tracks them). It does what language models do well — understand language and reason about goals — and delegates everything else to components that are exact, authorized, logged, and queryable.

260 primitives. 20 categories. Positive credential gating. Async execution. KB-stored results. Versioned artifacts. Direct data download. Command tokens. Operational environments. Everything logged. Everything auditable. Everything surfaceable.

The system can think, compute, execute, store, verify, and explain. Each capability is a separate component with clear interfaces. No component does another’s job. The result is not a faster language model or a more capable language model. It is a trustworthy computational system with a language model as its interface.

Appendix A: Complete Primitive Index

#	Name	Category	Type
1-17	string *	String	Pure
18-53	list *	List	Pure
54-79	vdr *	Arithmetic	Pure
80-93	set *	Set	Pure
94-108	dict *	Dictionary	Pure
109-124	vec , mat	Linear Algebra	Pure

#	Name	Category	Type
125-140	stat , <i>prob</i> , softmax*	Statistics	Pure
141-154	to , <i>format</i> , parse , <i>number to</i>	Conversion	Pure
155-164	date , <i>time</i> , duration *	Date/Time	Pure
165-172	hash , <i>base64</i> , hex , <i>crc32</i> , <i>uuid</i>	Hashing	Pure
173-185	graph *	Graph	Pure
186-192	regex , <i>glob</i> , wildcard *	Pattern	Pure
193-203	if then else, case match, for each, repeat n, while loop, try catch, assert that, type check, is bound, findall, aggregate	Logic	Pure
204-218	kb , <i>constraint</i>	KB/Constraint	Pure (KB-internal)
219-233	fs *	Filesystem	Operational
234-237	compile *	Compilation	Operational
238-242	exec *	Execution	Operational
243-250	lint , <i>analyze</i> , count lines	Linting	Operational
251-255	net *	Network	Operational
256-262	proc *	Process	Operational

Appendix B: Command Token Reference

Token Type	Arguments	Grant Required	Async	Side Effect
PURE FN	primitive, args	No	No	None
OP FN	primitive, args, env, grant	Yes	Optional	Declared per primitive
KB ASSERT	kb, fact	No (scoped)	No	KB state
KB RETRACT	kb, fact	No (scoped)	No	KB state
KB QUERY	kb, predicate, args	No (scoped)	No	None

Token Type	Arguments	Grant Required	Async	Side Effect
ENV EXEC	env, command, args	Yes	Recommended	Process creation
ENV UPLOAD	env, content, path	Yes	No	File creation
ENV DOWN- LOAD	env, path	Yes	No	Data transfer
CTX ACTIVATE	kb	No	No	Context state
CTX DEAC- TIVATE	kb	No	No	Context state
CTX SNAPSHOT	name	No	No	KB creation
VERSION CREATE	project, artifact, content, notes	No	No	KB state
VERSION TAG	project, artifact, version, tag	No	No	KB state
STORE RESULT	task id, kb, key	No	No	KB state
DIRECT OUTPUT	resource address	No (visibility-gated)	No	Data to user
ATTACHMENT	resource address, filename	Yes (read grant)	No	File to user

Appendix C: Grant Class Reference

Class	Operations	Typical Scope	Risk Level
filesystem	read, write, append, create dir, delete, move, copy	Directory path	Medium (write), Low (read)
compile	compile python check, compile zig, compile c, compile rust	Source directory	Low-Medium
execute	exec python, exec shell, exec zig test, exec pytest, exec script	Working directory	High

Class	Operations	Typical Scope	Risk Level
lint	lint python, lint zig, lint json, lint markdown, analyze *	Source directory	Low (read-only)
network	net download, net fetch, net post, net ping, net dns resolve	URL pattern or wildcard	Medium
process	proc start, proc poll, proc wait, proc kill, proc stdout, proc stderr, proc list	Environment	Medium-High

Appendix D: Paper Series

Paper	Registry	Central Result
VDR-1	[HOWL-VDR-1-2026]	Exact arithmetic in irreducible triple form
VDR-2	[HOWL-VDR-2-2026]	15 domains, 282 tests, chaos boundary
VDR-3	[HOWL-VDR-3-2026]	23 domains, transcendental integration, no unique boundaries
VDR-4	[HOWL-VDR-4-2026]	24-module ML stack, working exact transformer
VDR-5	[HOWL-VDR-5-2026]	Prolog provenance, constraints, scoped KBs, surfacing
VDR-6	[HOWL-VDR-6-2026]	260 primitives, command tokens, operational environments, versioning
MATH-3	[HOWL-MATH-3-2026]	Elliptic integrals, Borwein acceleration
MATH-4	[HOWL-MATH-4-2026]	Q335 universal basis, 22 constants

END HOWL-VDR-6-2026

Registry: [\[HOWL-VDR-6-2026\]](#)

Status: Specification complete

Domain: Applied Philosophy / Systems Architecture / Exact Computation

Central Result: 260 computational primitives (216 pure, 44 operational) across 20 categories, command token mechanism for structured LLM output, operational environments with unified interface, positive credential gating, async task management, versioning, and direct data download.

Foundation: VDR-1 through VDR-5, MATH-3, MATH-4

Key Principle: Separation of concerns. The LLM understands intent. Primitives compute. Environments execute. KBs store. Constraints authorize. Surfacing presents. No component does another's job.

Falsification: Seven specific criteria testable by exact comparison and integration testing.

[[HOWL-VDR-6-2026](#)] Computational Primitives and Operational Environments. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/VDR/HOWL-VDR-6-2026>

[[HOWL-VDR-1-2026](#)] VDR Arithmetic: Value, Decimal, Remainder. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/VDR/HOWL-VDR-1-2026>

[[HOWL-VDR-2-2026](#)] VDR Gym: Exact Arithmetic Across Fifteen Domains. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/VDR/HOWL-VDR-2-2026>

[[HOWL-MATH-3-2026](#)] The Transcendental Hierarchy. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/MATH-3-2026>

[[HOWL-MATH-4-2026](#)] The Universal Power-of-Two Basis. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/MATH-4-2026>

[[HOWL-VDR-3-2026](#)] VDR Gym Extension. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/VDR/HOWL-VDR-3-2026>

[[HOWL-VDR-4-2026](#)] Exact-Fraction Language Model Architecture. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/VDR/HOWL-VDR-4-2026>

[[HOWL-LLM-1-2026](#)] Integer LLM with Prolog Knowledge Base. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/LLM/HOWL-LLM-1-2026>

[[HOWL-VDR-5-2026](#)] Exact Arithmetic Meets Logical Provenance. Github: <https://github.com/ghowland/papers/tree/main/papers/VDR/HOWL-VDR-5-2026>